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THE PLAYER'S PAGE

The latest trends, tips and reviews on video games

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THE 411

News and developments from the game industry

An arcade in your house, minus the riffraff

Affluent video game historians and arcade aficionados will be interested to learn that DreamAuthentics recently launched the Katana, a personal arcade box of table- or bar-top design.

Like DreamAuthentics' original, full-sized arcade cabinet reproduction, the Excalibur, the Katana is basically a custom cabinet featuring a built-in PC with a 17-inch LCD monitor.

While also acting as a jukebox with built-in MP3 player software — and a movie/media player, Web browser, and e-mail system — the Katana's key feature is the old-school arcade interface out in front, including an authentic trackball, joystick, classic concave buttons and an (optional) arcade spinner/paddle wheel, which also accommodates a mini racing wheel.

DreamAuthentics.

Play a multitude of games in your home with DreamAuthentics' Kantana.

Out of the box, it comes bundled with 200 fully licensed classic games installed, most of which really only work faithfully with controllers that no videogame console nor PC keyboard can accommodate — things like "Centipede" and "Tempest" with the paddle wheel, "Missile Command" with the trackball, and the bang and button-pump of "Dig Dug" with a tenaciously tolerant joystick.

With various customization options available, the Katana starts at — are you ready? — $2,500.

More info at www.dreamauthentics.com.